



**MEETING MINUTES
LANCASTER COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
TUESDAY, DECEMBER 23, 2025, AT 9:00 AM
COUNTY-CITY BUILDING, ROOM 112**

**COMMISSIONERS: Rick Vest, Chair; Christa Yoakum, Vice Chair;
Sean Flowerday, Chelsea Johnson, and Matt Schulte**

Advance public notice of the meeting was posted on the County-City Building bulletin board, posted to the Lancaster County, Nebraska website, emailed to the media, and published in the Lincoln Journal Star print and digital editions on December 19, 2025.

Commissioners present: Rick Vest, Chair
Christa Yoakum, Vice Chair
Sean Flowerday

Commissioners absent: Chelsea Johnson
Matt Schulte

Others present: David Derbin, Chief Administrative Officer
Kristy Bauer, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer
John Ward, Deputy County Attorney
Morgan Sanchez, Deputy County Attorney
Matt Hansen, County Clerk
Meggan Funke, County Clerk's Office

Vest called the meeting to order at 9:03 a.m. and led the Pledge of Allegiance. The Clerk announced the location of the Nebraska Open Meetings Act.

1. MINUTES – Approval of the minutes of the Board of Commissioners meeting held on December 16, 2025.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the minutes. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

2. CLAIMS

A. Approval of the claims processed through December 19, 2025.

MOTION: Yoakum moved and Flowerday seconded approval of the claims. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

B. Approval of a claim to El Centro de las Americas in the amount of \$10,148.11 (Batch 328636, Document 912700).

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Vest seconded approval of the claim. Flowerday and Vest voted yes. Yoakum abstained. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 2-0 with one abstention.

C. Approval of the claims for goods and services beyond the 90-day time period provided in Neb. Rev. Stat. §23-135:

1. Benesch & Company for a total of \$4,261. (Batch 328585 and 328645, Document 912645 and 912871)
2. Felsburg, Holt & Ullevig for a total of \$3,300. (Batch 328697, Document 912913)

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the claims. Flowerday, Yoakum, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

3. CONSENT ITEMS –These are routine business items that are expected to be adopted without dissent. Any individual item may be removed for special discussion and consideration by a Commissioner or by any member of the public without prior notice. Unless there is an exception, these items will be approved as one with a single vote of the Board of Commissioners. These items are approval of:

A. Amendments to the following County contracts:

1. C-25-0090 with US Bank National Association (US Bank) for commercial card services. (State of Washington/NASPO Master Agreement 00719, State of Nebraska Participating Addendum 111680 O4, W-031. The contract renews January 1, 2026, to December 31, 2026. There is no anticipated cost to the County.) (C-25-0951)
2. C-23-0050 with Judson Irrigation Inc for irrigation maintenance and repair services. (Bid 22-260. The amendment renews the contract from March 1, 2026, to February 28, 2027. The cost is not to exceed \$20,000.) (C-25-0957)
3. C-18-0155 with Graybar Electric Company Inc for electrical, lighting, data communications, security products, and related services. (OMNIA/US Communities Contract EV2370, MOU019. The amendment renews the contract from February 1, 2026, to January 31, 2027. The estimated cost is not to exceed \$30,000.) (C-25-0960)
4. C-24-0918 with Kidwell Inc for replacing existing coax cable with CAT6 cable services. (Bid 24-202. The amendment extends the contract from November 2, 2025, to May 1, 2026. The cost will not change and not exceed \$279,996.) (C-25-0958)
5. C-24-0919 with Kidwell Inc for the removal of existing analog camera and replacement with new digital camera services. (Bid 24-201. The amendment extends the contract from November 2, 2025, to May 1, 2026. The cost will not change and not exceed \$144,300.) (C-25-0959)
6. C-25-0068 with Michael Todd & Co Inc for snowplow nuts, bolts, and washers supplies. (Quote 6688. The amendment renews the contract from February 4, 2026, to February 3, 2027. The cost is not to exceed \$5,000.) (C-25-0962)

B. Right-of-way contracts with the following:

1. B&W Landon Family Farms LLC, 176th Street and Greenwood Road, driveway replacement in lieu of payment. (Project 26-24/A-023) (C-25-0952)
2. Lee Raymond Benes, Northwest 27th Street and West Little Salt Road, in the amount of \$163. (Project 25-24/C-096) (C-25-0955)

C. Change Order 3 to County contract C-24-0940 with Genesis Contracting Group LLC for construction at the SquareOne Family Resource Center. (Bid 24-212. The change order increases the contracted sum by \$221,340.27 for parking lot upgrades and storm pipe relocation. The new total contract sum including this change order is \$2,049,506.28.) (C-25-0954)

D. Change Order 2 to County contract C-25-0114 with Van Kirk Bros Contracting to extend the project to January 31, 2026. (Project 24-54; Bid 25-0041. The contract will still be considered a 50-working day contract. There is no additional cost to the County.) (C-25-0956)

MOTION: Yoakum moved and Flowerday seconded approval of the consent items. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

4. NEW BUSINESS

- A.** Resolution in the matter of annual salary increases for appointed directors, assistant directors, bailiffs, and the child support referee. (R-25-0094)

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the resolution. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- B.** Special event permit application from Scott Wieskamp for the 2026 Animal Run to be held on February 7, 2026, from 10:00 a.m. to 11:00 a.m.

MOTION: Yoakum moved and Flowerday seconded approval of the special events permit application. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- C.** Agreement with Lutheran Family Services of Nebraska Inc to provide Nurturing Fathers educational workshops to inmates at County Corrections. There is no cost to the County. (C-25-0953)

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the agreement. Flowerday, Yoakum, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- D.** Contract with General Excavating to provide repairs to County Bridge K-144 (21-59). The cost is not to exceed \$218,268.42. (Bid 25-198. The contract shall be effective upon execution by both parties.) (C-25-0950)

Larry Legg, Assistant County Engineer, presented a map (Exhibit 1) and explained that the project involves a bridge deck overlay and is located east of 84th Street near the Sandhills Global Event Center.

MOTION: Yoakum moved and Flowerday seconded approval of the contract. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- E.** Notice to proceed with a purchase from Motorola Solutions of license plate readers at a cost of \$793,715.71. (Prices, terms, and conditions pursuant to NASPO Agreement OK-MA-145-21-500, Attachment D, and State of Nebraska Participating Agreement 16087 OC. Products are not to be delivered without separate written approval from the County Sheriff's Department.) (C-25-0961)

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the notice to proceed contract. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- F.** Lancaster County Risk Management Director classification description.

Jon Thober, Human Resources Total Rewards Division Leader, noted updates were made to modernize the classification.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the classification. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- G.** Centene Corporation re-credential application for the Mental Health Crisis Center's participation in government-sponsored healthcare programs.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the application. Flowerday, Yoakum, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

Vest invited Ben Houchin, Chief Deputy Sheriff to speak on item 4E. Houchin explained that the notice to proceed was requested to secure current pricing while the Sheriff's Office awaits final confirmation of federal grant funding, delayed by the federal government shutdown. He stated the Sheriff's Office would return to the Board for final authorization upon receipt of grant funds.

Vest referenced prior discussions and expressed continued concern regarding privacy and data usage. Houchin explained that license plate readers are used only for authorized law enforcement purposes and are governed by state statute. For example, the maximum data retention period is 180 days unless it is associated with an active investigation. He stated the technology requires verification prior to any enforcement action. Flowerday noted that statutory safeguards include criminal penalties for misuse of data.

- H. Schedule of Benefits for Stop Loss insurance coverage with Symetra Life Insurance Company for the County's health insurance plans for the period beginning January 1, 2026, and ending December 31, 2026. The estimated maximum cost to the County is \$1,628,855.

Thober explained the purposes for the stop-loss insurance and noted the premium increase was consistent with industry norms.

MOTION: Yoakum moved and Flowerday seconded approval of the insurance. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- I. Adoption of the 2026-2028 Lancaster County Strategic Plan.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Yoakum seconded approval of the strategic plan.

The Board acknowledged former Commissioner Roma Amundsen for her foundational role in initiating the strategic planning process.

Tracy Aksamit, County resident, expressed concerns about data collection related to social determinants of mental health and presented a flyer on data and personal rights (Exhibit 2).

Lisa Kort-Butler, on behalf of Justice in Action, expressed support for the strategic plan for community-based public safety strategies.

Harry Heafer, a County resident, advocated for assisted listening systems and the need to improve their accessibility. He presented his business cards (Exhibit 3).

Spike Eickholt, on behalf of the American Civil Liberties Union in Nebraska, expressed support for the justice-related objectives in the strategic plan.

Roma Amundsen, a former county commissioner, expressed her support for the second iteration of the strategic plan and acknowledged the hard work put into the process.

Mike Sciandra, Nebraska Council on Problem Gambling Executive Director, emphasized the need to include prevention efforts for gambling in the strategic plan. He presented the Board with his business card (Exhibit 4).

ROLL CALL: Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.

- 5. **PUBLIC COMMENT** - Members of the public wishing to speak on items relating to County business not on the agenda may do so at this time. Each speaker is limited to one appearance of up to five minutes, and that time may not be reserved, transferred, or otherwise assigned to other speakers. These time limits may be extended or reasonably decreased at the discretion of the Chair.

Harry Heafer, County resident, expressed concerns regarding hearing accessibility and requested that the commissioners and speakers use the microphones.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

- A.** The Board of Commissioners will be adjourned and hold no meetings from Wednesday, December 24, 2025, through Monday, January 5, 2026.
- B.** The Board of Commissioners will hold its next regular meeting on Tuesday, January 6, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. with the Board of Equalization immediately following in Room 112 of the County-City Building (555 S. 10th Street, Lincoln).
- C.** County Commissioners can be reached at 402-441-7447 or commish@lancaster.ne.gov.
- D.** The Lancaster County Board of Commissioners meeting is broadcast live on LNKTv (LNKTv.lincoln.ne.gov). LNKTv is available on Allo channel 2 and Spectrum channel 1300. For the rebroadcast schedule visit lincoln.ne.gov (keyword: LNKTv). Meetings are also streamed live on YouTube and Facebook (youtube.com/@lancastercountynebraska/streams and Facebook.com/lancasterne). LNKTv apps are also available on Roku, Apple TV, and Amazon Fire TV.

6. ADJOURNMENT

MOTION: Yoakum moved and Flowerday seconded to adjourn at 9:36 a.m. Yoakum, Flowerday, and Vest voted yes. Johnson and Schulte were absent. Motion carried 3-0.



Matt Hansen
Lancaster County Clerk



Lancaster County, Nebraska

Repair of County Bridge K-144

Project No. 21-59

EXHIBIT

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MY DATA MY RIGHTS

He who rules the data, rules the world—
Forbes, 2017

THE STATE OF NE IS COLLECTING ALL OF YOUR HEALTH DATA

Data rules our world, but who rules the data?

Our medical information is being captured and shared without our consent by a centralized data and surveillance system.

According to lawmakers, our data will be used by doctors to improve patient care. However, critics warn the system marks a step toward the oppressive control of digital ID and digital currency that could sweep the U.S.

NE IS THE PILOT FOR A NATIONAL PROGRAM

With the passage of LB 1183 in 2020, the Health Information Technology (HIT) Board managed by CyncHealth was created. In 2021, LB 411 required all Nebraskans (via health care providers and pharmacies) to participate. In other words, the legislation permitted the state to collect all of your personal health data into one health data utility. Many Nebraskans remain unaware of this. In addition, CyncHealth has a \$14 million-a-year contract with Nebraska (Nebraska Examiner, 2022). And, under its former name, Nebraska Health Information Initiative, CyncHealth is a member of CARIN Alliance, which is devoted to global digital ID credentials. Other members of the Alliance include Google and Microsoft.

WHAT CAN YOU DO

1. Connect with CHD NE

CHD NE has resources to help you learn about your medical rights. Visit our homepage: ne.childrenshd.org to see them and sign up for updates.

2. Spread the Word

Educate other Nebraskans including your representative and the governor using links on the legislative resource page of the CHD NE website.

3. Consider Opting-Out

LB 411 opted you in. Nebraskans can also opt out. Visit the CyncHealth homepage of cynchealth.org to complete the form to opt-out of having your data collected.

4. Observe HIT Board Meetings

Tune in. They are public meetings. HIT Board meetings are held four times a year. Visit the CyncHealth homepage or visit the state of Nebraska Public Meetings Calendar web page to register.



QUESTIONS REMAIN

- Will interagency sharing of data including across medical providers and systems impact our personal information, privacy, and exposure to hacking or data breaches?
- What are the ramifications of the violation of informed consent to release or share personal information?
- Is this Constitutional? The HIT Board was established, but is there authority granted to the state to control health, healthcare, or health-related data in the Nebraska Constitution?

INFORMATIONAL LINKS

- Carin Alliance, carinalliance.com
- CyncHealth/HIT Board, cynchealth.org
- Lincoln's Open Source
<https://www.lincolnsopensource.com/hit-board-social-care-standards/>
- Nebraska Collecting All Health Data on All Residents
childrenshealthdefense.org/nebraska-health-data-collection-residents-digital-id
- Nebraska Constitution
nebraskalegislature.gov/FloorDocs/Current/PDF/Constitution/constitution.pdf
- Nebraska Examiner, nebraskaexaminer.com/briefs/state-pays-overdue-11-million-in-bills-to-provider-of-health-care-data

Children's
Health Defense
NEBRASKA CHAPTER



ne.chd@childrenshealthdefense.org
ne.childrenshd.org
childrenshd.org

CHD represents the interests of millions world-wide. It conducts litigation when children's health is violated and is engaged in education and establishing safeguards to prevent harm. CHD NE protects the fundamental rights of all Nebraskans including our youth.



Lydia Teegerstrom & Harry Heafer
Co-Chairs

Meeting at 9:00 am every 3rd Saturday of the month
Unitarian Church of Lincoln, 6300 A Street

(Hearing loop and wheelchair accessible)

hlaalincolnne@gmail.com

www.HearingLoss.org

www.CenterForHearingLoss.org



HLAA
Lincoln
Facebook



EXHIBIT

tabbles®

3

Center for
Hearing Access

Harry Heafer
Co-Chair

HLAA-Lincoln Hearing Loss Support Group
Volunteer Hearing Loss Advocate
Hearing Loop, Telecoil &
Assistive Listening Systems

hheafer@neb.rr.com

www.CenterForHearingAccess.org

www.HearingLoss.org

www.time2LoopAmerica.com



HLAA
Lincoln
Facebook



We offer a free, welcoming space for people who have all types of hearing loss and loves ones to share experiences, gain valuable insights on hearing loss, and enrich our lives through support. You don't have to have hearing loss to attend.

- Discover new hearing loss resources
- Trade stories and advice
- Make new friends
- Learn about new technology
- Get recommendations and referrals
- Help your friends and family understand hearing loss
- No Sales pitches - Education, Sharing and Advocacy

Hearing Loss Resources

www.CenterForHearingAccess.org

www.HearingLoss.org

Hearing Loops

- transmit sound from public address systems wirelessly to any hearing aid or cochlear implant with a telecoil
- deliver sound customized for one's own hearing loss pattern
- do not require those with telecoil hearing devices to seek, wear and return special equipment and are, for this reason, user-preferred
- are cost effective and inconspicuous to use
- accommodate one or hundreds of users at the same time
- can also work with portable receivers for those who do not use a hearing device or loopbuds with a smartphone

For more information: www.CenterForHearingAccess.org

Mike Sciandra, MA, CPSS, IGRS, BARA
Executive Director

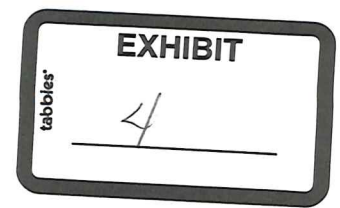
Follow NeCPG on
Facebook, LinkedIn,
and YouTube

402-217-1500 (cell)
betfreemike@gmail.com



4435 O Street, Suite 110
Lincoln, Nebraska 68510

www.necpg.org



County Board Meeting

Please print your name and department

NAME

DEPARTMENT OR ADDRESS

Harry Heater

Spice B. 1266 W

Acce of McCarren